सीमाशुल्क प्रधान आयुक्त(आयात)का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE PRINCIPAL COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS (IMPORT)
हवाई माल संकुल, सहार, अंधेरी(पूर्व), मुंबई -४०००९९
AIR CARGO COMPLEX, SAHAR, ANDHERI (EAST), MUMBAI – 400 099
Email ID: *pro.acc-sahar@gov.in*

Date: 07.11.2025

MINUTES OF THE PERMANENT TRADE FACILITATION COMMITTEE MEETING HELD ON 30.10.2025

The meeting of Permanent Trade Facilitation Committee (PTFC), for the month of October 2025, was held in the Conference Hall of ACC at 03:00 PM on 30.10.2025 and was chaired by Shri Manish Chandra, Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import) and Co-chaired by Shri Hardeep Batra, Commissioner of Customs (Export). The following officers and representatives participated in the meeting:

Sl. No.	Name & Designation	Organization
1	Shri Tagadi Manjunath, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
2	Smt. Daribha Lyndem, Joint Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
3	Shri G.L Narsimham, Deputy Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
4	Shri Rajesh Ramlal Solanki, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (SIIB(I))	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
5	Shri M. Sree Harsha, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
6	Shri K. Poddar, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
7	Shri I Ramalingeswara Rao, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Group VA)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
8	Shri Umesh S. Choughle, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
9	Shri Girraj L Meena, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
10	Shri Jai Singh Rathore, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export E&T)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
11	Smt. Manisha S. Jadhav, Superintendent of Customs (Export E&T)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
12	Shri Sudhir, Appraiser (Technical Cell)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
13	Shri Shashank Shekhar, Examiner (Technical Cell)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
14	Shri Sourav Kumar, Examiner (Technical Cell)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
15	Shri Vishal Kumar, Preventive Officer (Export, E&T)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai

Sl. No.	Name of attendees of Stakeholders	Organization
1	Shri Hiren Joshi, Deputy Task Manager	AIASL
2	Shri Kamlesh C. Sawant, Terminal Manager	AIASL
3	Shri V. P. Salunke, Executive Operations	AIASL
4	Shri Sanjay Ghag, Sr. Manager	MIAL
5	Shri Subodh Thakur, Manager	MIAL
6	Shri Amit Kadam, Associate Manager	MIAL
7	Shri Naresh Kumar, Deputy Manager	MIAL
8	Shri Mahesh Boculay, Sr. Manager, Import	Sequel One
9	Shri Atish Hirve, Deputy Manager	Sequel One
10	Shri Vikas A. Shinde, Technical Officer	CDSCO
11	Smt. Jitha KK, Joint Director	FSSAI
12	Shri Jankiram Kadam, Technical Officer	FSSAI
13	Dr. Rashmi Pandey, Assistant Director	PQ
14	Shri Rajen S Bhatia, Chairman	ACAAI
15	Shri Shailesh Sharma, Secretary	ACAAI
16	Shri Dushyant Mulani, IMM Past Chairman	FFFAI
17	Shri Kaushal Thakkar, Import Chairman	BCBA
18	Shri Kiran Ramshia, Advisor	BCBA
19	Shri Sanjeev H., President	BCBA
20	Shri Sandeep B. Kadam, Advisor	BCBA
21	Shri Kalyan Nawpute, MCM	BCBA
22	Shri Ketan Desai, Secretary	BCBA
23	Shri C.B. Walahallu, Asstt. Manager	Export
24	Shri Yogesh Thoinbra, Asstt. Manager	Export
25	Shri Anirudh Shelavkar, OPS Sup	Lufthansa Cargo
26	Shri Harish Zade, Supervisor	Lufthansa Cargo
27	Shri Vaibhav Dhuru, CGO officer	Cathay Pacific Airways
28	Shri Sudhir Manipur, Manager	UR

The Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import) welcomed all the attendees. There was no open point for discussion from the last PTFC meeting. The following agenda points were taken up for discussion and decision:-

AGENDA POINTS RECEIVED FROM TRADE/STAKEHOLDERS

1) Delay in Frivolous Queries Resulting in Delayed OOC

The BCBA has raised the issue regarding increasing trend of 'frivolous' or avoidable queries being raised at the time of Out-of-Charge (OOC). This has led to longer dwell times, increased transaction costs, and missed delivery deadlines. BCBA requests the Department to verify these observations internally and to ensure consistent monitoring of

query quality and relevance—especially as the TRS week approaches in the first week of January.

Discussion and Decision:

Principal Commissioner of Customs said that no 'frivolous' queries are raised. If such queries are actually raised, they should be brought to the notice of Pr. Commissioner immediately.

Import Shed officers have been instructed not to raise avoidable or repetitive queries to ensure normal operations and timely OOC. All queries are to be justified.

Principal Commissioner advised the BCBA and Trade to refer to Public Notice No. 51/2025 dated 14.10.2025 wherein Annexure – I specifies the list of documents to be uploaded at the time of filing of Bill of Entry. The BCBA and Importer may escalate any issue being faced at Import Shed to AC/DC and JC, Shed.

(Point Closed)

---

2) BE Routed through PGA Should Not Be Referred to PGA for NOC Manually

The BCBA has pointed out that certain Bills of Entry (BEs), though routed through the Participating Government Agency (PGA) Module, are again being manually referred to the same PGA for NOC issuance. This duplication causes unnecessary delays. The BCBA has requested that suitable instructions should be issued to ensure that once a BE is routed through the PGA System, no separate manual referral is required to the same PGA.

Discussion and Decision:

Principal Commissioner informed that for those Bills of Entry, where NOC from the Participating Government Agency (PGA) are not received through official channel and an unsigned copy of NOC is submitted by CBs, officers ask the CBs to get the copy of the NOC to be counter signed by the PGAs (mainly FSSAI). This safeguards from any possible mis-use and ensures the genuineness of the physical copy of NOC.

Joint Director, FSSAI, Smt. Jitha KK informed that due to a time lag issue in System, it takes time in transmitting the NOC message to Customs. The issue has been escalated to DG Systems.

Assistant Director, PQ, Dr. Rashmi Pandey informed that the NOC issued by PQ authority is embedded with a secure QR code that Customs officials can scan to instantly verify the authenticity and details of the certificate.

Principal Commissioner advised all the PGA representatives to make efforts to integrate their respective Systems with the Indian Customs EDI System (ICES) to enable more efficient Customs clearance. This should be escalated to the PGA HQs for information and necessary action. In the meantime, such cases should be brought to the notice of PGAs through the established messaging channel created.

(Point Closed)
Action : All PGAs

---

3) Auto Allocation of BoE after Night Shift Change

In this agenda point, BCBA requested for implementing an auto-allocation mechanism for BoE. If a query is raised by the Shed Officer especially in the Night Shift and the Importer / CB has replied after the shift change, then such BoE are allocated only after the CB approaches the Shed DC, which results in delays. Such delays are compounded if the same are encountered during weekend. Hence, the BCBA has requested that an automated allocation of BoE mechanism to be adopted to reduce the clearance timelines & avoiding physical interaction with the department officers.

Discussion and Decision:

Assistant Commissioner of Customs, Import Shed informed that for Bills of Entry where queries are raised during night shift, any reply submitted by the trade is transmitted by System to the night officer's ID by the System. The subsequent day, re-allocation of such BoEs is done by the AC Shed to a day officer for further action. This ensures appropriate follow-up on pending BoEs and is done to maintain accountability and efficient handover between shifts, minimizing delays resulting from shift changes. It has to be noted here that such queries are minimal.

The BCBA Representative informed that at weekend or holidays, when there is no AC at Shed, re-allocation issue leads to delay in clearance of urgent consignments.

Principal Commissioner of Customs advised the BCBA to submit a representation for escalating the matter to DG Systems.

(Point Closed)
Action : BCBA

---

4) Display of Visiting Hours of Senior Customs Officers

The BCBA has requested that the visiting hours of senior Customs officers should be displayed prominently so that trade members can plan their visits for official work accordingly.

Discussion and Decision:

Principal Commissioner informed that all Customs Officers are available to meet trade representatives during office hours to address their concerns. Trade/visitors may also seek appointment so that such meetings can be held with preparation and without visitors having to wait.

(Point Closed)

---

5) Issue in ICEGATE System Regarding BG Selection for BoE Filed with Two Licenses

The BCBA has pointed out that when a Bill of Entry is filed using two licenses, the ICEGATE system automatically selects the Bank Guarantee (BG). The BCBA has requested that this issue should be escalated to ICEGATE authorities for suitable rectification.

Discussion and Decision:

It was discussed that when a BE is filed under License with Bond details, the System captures BG by default. ADC (I) further asked BCBA representative to submit Case Studies for such Bills of Entry so that the issue may be analysed for further action. (In such cases, Bill of Entry is recalled for BG deletion).

(Point Closed)
Action : BCBA

---

6) Infrastructure Challenges for Exports

The BCBA has raised concerns that during the week preceding festive holidays, significant congestion was observed in dock areas due to improper vehicle management and prioritization of import traffic. This leads to cascading delays in export operations. Additionally, recurring manpower shortages at export docks are resolved only temporarily after complaints are raised.

Despite consistent annual increases in custodian charges, service quality remains below expected levels. The BCBA emphasized that ACC Mumbai, being one of the country's largest international cargo hubs, should set service benchmarks comparable to or better than other leading ports.

Discussion and Decision:

The MIAL Representative, informed that separate lanes have been designated for Export and Import vehicles. During the festive period, Import vehicles were consistently

given priority over Export vehicles. This prioritization was primarily due to the regular availability of the Import Dock, whereas the Export Dock remained occupied for extended durations on the account of heavy export congestion during festival period. As a result, Export vehicles faced delays in accessing the Dock, impacting overall turnaround time. There is no manpower shortage at MIAL.

Commissioner of Customs (Export) instructed MIAL Representative to monitor the process of handling the urgent cargo on priority basis. Commissioner (Export) also asked MIAL representative to ensure making flexible arrangements during festive days for enabling normal handling of consignments as the existing infrastructural structure is not sufficient to handle the spike in consignments and there is a need for upgradation of the infrastructure. Principal Commissioner stated that MIAL may consider System improvements/upgradations and introduce Software Application for scheduling cargo movements as per exporters/importers online requests using such application. MIAL may study such systems in place at other Ports/Airports.

(Point Closed)
Action : MIAL/AIASL

7) System Issues Regarding CARR & SB Prints

The BCBA has highlighted that the CARR System issues persist despite repeated representations from the trade. The BCBA has requested a root-cause analysis and a permanent resolution. Furthermore, several members report non-receipt of Shipping Bill (SB) prints after LEO. The BCBA recommends setting up a dedicated desk for prompt SB print generation.

Discussion and Decision:

Commissioner (Export) informed that Custodians such as AIASL and AMAX have portals linked to the ICES system for transmitting the carting information of goods. However, there have been repeated delays due to technical issues, specifically on 17.08.2025, 24.09.2025, 18.10.2025, 24.10.2025, and 27.10.2025, even when ICEGATE remained operational. These glitches are generally traced to the Custodians' data transmission processes and accordingly a communication is then sent to Custodians to rectify the issue of timely data transmission which is generally resolved at their end.

Commissioner (Export) informed that the 1.5 ICES System provides exporters and shippers with the facility to generate the LEO (Let Export Order) copy after the LEO is granted by the Customs officer, but due to technical glitches, some users face difficulty retrieving LEO copies even after approval. In the last three months, it has been noted that this issue has occurred around 30–40 times, though no formal complaints have been submitted to Customs. To assist affected exporters and shippers, the Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export Shed) provides manual printouts of the LEO copies in these cases.

For better monitoring and analysis of these issues, separate registers have been maintained to log each issue capturing the data like error type, resolution time, Profile of Shippers/Exporters (Type, Mobile No, SB filing date etc), any other irregularity to analyse the root cause of such faults in the System and enable improvements.

(Point Closed)

---

8) Scanning Issues at Heavy Shed No. 4

The BCBA has raised an issue on behalf of Trade that the Scanner at Gate No. 4 (Heavy Shed) is not functioning optimally, leading to delays in Carting. Unlike General Cargo Shed, where the goods are first Carted in EXPORT SHED and at a later stage SCANNING is done (Mostly after LEO is granted), the same is not the case in HEAVY SHED where in Scanning is done first and later the Goods Registration is done. The BCBA has requested that the Department should closely monitor and expedite Scanning operations for Heavy Packages.

Discussion and Decision:

The MIAL representative informed that due to continuous operation, these Scanning machines face technical issues which leads to break down of the machines. At present, 1 machine out of 07 machines is not working.

Commissioner (Export) observed that there is a practice of scanning packages before LEO in Heavy Shed (Export). Commissioner (Export) asked BCBA to submit a report on the volume of Export Cargo and status of Scanning machines in Heavy Shed.

Commissioner (Export) instructed Shri Girraj L Meena, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export Shed) to arrange for a meeting with MIAL and BCBA to analyse and discuss these issues of Heavy Shed (Export).

(Point Closed)
Action : MIAL & Export Commissionerate

---

9) Clarification Regarding "OPEN" & "EXAMINE" Orders for Shipping Bills

The BCBA has highlighted that for the non-facilitated Shipping Bills covering Pharma, Haz-Cargo & other sensitive materials, "OPEN" and "EXAMINE" orders should be restrained unless a Sample is to be drawn. Unnecessary opening increases contamination risk in Pharma goods and safety hazards in hazardous cargo. The BCBA requested that

the examination orders should be issued judiciously, and expert handling be ensured wherever such cargo is involved.

Discussion and Decision:

Commissioner (Export) informed that as per Public Notice No. 14/2014, it is instructed that: "appraising and examination instructions communicated by the RMS have to be followed by the Officers involved in assessing and/or examining the export consignments.". Hence it becomes an obligation to open and examine the shipments when instructed by RMS. Also, as per Circular No. 43/2005-Cus dated 24.11.2005, "it is possible that in a few cases, the field formations might decide to apply a particular treatment to the BE which is at variance with the decision received from the RMS owing to risks which are not factored in the RMS. Such a course of action shall however be taken only with the prior approval of the jurisdictional Commissioner of Customs or an officer authorized by him for this purpose, who shall not be below the rank of Addl./Joint Commissioner of Customs, and after recording the reasons for the same." However, this process cannot be avoided only because of sensitive or perishable nature of consignments.

(Point Closed)

---

10) Issue of Airport Entry Permits (EPs)

BCBA has raised concerns that the BCBA members are facing difficulties during re-registration with the Pass Section due to the requirement of physical verification of original documents, which is impractical when Head Offices are located all across the country. The BCBA recommends that verification be conducted through online credentials such like ROC Credentials, GST, CB License, etc.

Furthermore, in line with Board Circulars providing lifetime validity for Customs Broker Licenses and Customs Passes, the BCBA requests that Entry Permits (EPs) also be granted lifetime validity.

Discussion and Decision:

Senior Manager, MIAL, Shri Sanjay Ghag, informed that due to a System crash, the previously uploaded documents could not be retrieved from the System. Hence, there is a requirement of for re-uploading of the documents on the official portal. He added that if scanned colour copies of the required documents are re-uploaded, physical verification will not be necessary.

(Point Closed)
Action : MIAL

The meeting ending after the foregoing discussions.

This issues with the approval of the Principal Commissioner of Customs, Import, ACC, Mumbai.

(Tagadi Manjunath)
Additional Commissioner of Customs,
Import, ACC, Mumbai - III

Copy :-

1. Pr. Commissioner/ Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General, ACC.
2. All Addl./JC Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General/Pr.CCO, ACC.
3. All member of PTFC meeting including BCBA & ACAAI (via e-mail).
4. DC/EDI for uploading on ACC website (via e-mail).
5. PGAs, ACC Mumbai (via e-mail).
6. Office copy.